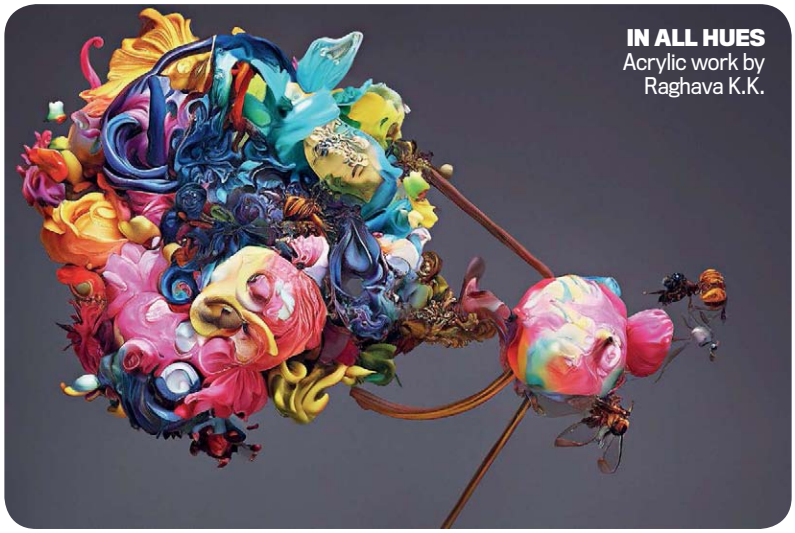
TECH X ART

Digital art is only getting bigger at the IAF each year. This year, Digital Residency Hub will showcase work by the three Digital Artists-in-Residence—Mira Felicia Malhotra, Gaurav Ogale and Varun Desai—all made in response to the theme 'Finding the Extraordinary in the Ordinary'. The Studio will also host projects supported by the Serendipity Arts and The Gujral Foundation with video and tech-inspired artworks presented by contemporary artists Sudarshan Shetty and Raghava K.K., respectively, along with digital animations and drawings by Shrimanti Saha in an interactive public project supported by The Foundation for Indian Contemporary Art.



IN ALL HUES
Acrylic work by Raghava K.K.

RAGHAVA KK STUDIO

Courtesy: ADITI KULKARNI & PAYAL ARYA



FLIGHT AND FLOWERS

Curated by Feroze Gujral, The Gujral Foundation is screening at *PIPIO: A Bird Flies, a Stone Is Thrown*, at the IAF. The film was created by Payal Arya and Aditi Kulkarni during their visit to FilmAkademie Baden-Württemberg GmbH in 2019-2020 and explores the idea of cyclic time and the associations between flying and guilt. Running in parallel to the IAF, multidisciplinary artist Raghava K.K.'s cutting-edge series of impossible bouquets is being showcased by the Foundation, which is celebrating its 15th year at 24, Jor Bagh, in New Delhi, from February 10 to 16.

ARTISTS IN RESIDENCE PROGRAMME

Championing a multiplicity of artistic practices, this programme features Debashish Paul's performance art piece about his queer identity, the Vayeda brothers' transformation of the fair's facade into a 'Forest of the Future' using their Warli traditions, and conceptual artist Lakshmi Madhavan's revisit of the dying kasavu textile tradition of Kerala.

THE FUTURE IS BORN OF ART



The seven-year partnership of the IAF and BMW India is being marked with a special commission entitled 'The Future is Born of Art', awarded to Devika Sundar, who is designing the wrap for the all-new BMW X7 in response to the theme 'Forwardism'. Her work will be a unique vision of a future where art, science and fiction meet. Shortlisted artists also included Aditi Aggarwal, Rithika Pandey and Sajid Wajid Shaikh.

FIRE IN THE BELLY

The IAF will publish a completely women-led poster zine titled *Fire in the Belly* for the 2023 edition, presenting the voices of eight artists and creative powerhouses—Anikesa Dhing, Aravani Art Project, Aqui Thami, Dhruvi Acharya, Meena Kandasamy, Rithika Pandey, Shilpa Gupta and Zeenat Kulavoor, each sharing her dreams, hopes, prayers and wisdom for an equal world.





STROKES OF GENIUS
(clockwise from left) work by Edwin Lord Weeks, Raja Ravi Varma, Asit Kumar Haldar and Francis Newton Souza

Over the years, the DAG has opened up galleries in New Delhi, Mumbai and New York

the repertoire of Indian art with works spanning 300 years of art practice in the subcontinent. The second edition of Iconic Masterpieces will debut simultaneously at two venues in New Delhi—the DAG's booth at the India Art Fair as well as its new gallery at Janpath.

The 50 artworks on display represent a stunning collection of artists, including the likes of Francis Newton Souza, M.F. Husain, S.H. Raza, Ganesh Haloi, Natvar Bhavsar, Krishen Khanna, Ram Kumar, Prabhakar Barwe, M.V. Dhurandhar and Nirode Mazumdar. Artworks to look out for include the first-ever commissioned painting made by Raja Ravi Varma, the only sculpture created by Amrita Sher-Gil, a rare painting from the Ramayana by Japanese master Shokin Katsuta, the largest scroll painted by Avinash Chandra, an oil painting by Thomas Daniell of hunting in India, and seminal works by artists Allah Bux and M.A.R. Chughtai, who went on to become Pakistan's most celebrated artists. ■

Amit Dixit